



THREAT ADVISORY

**ACTOR
REPORT**

LockBit 3.0 makes a comeback by exploiting Log4j

Date of Publication

August 03, 2022

Admiralty code

A1

TA Number

TA2022162

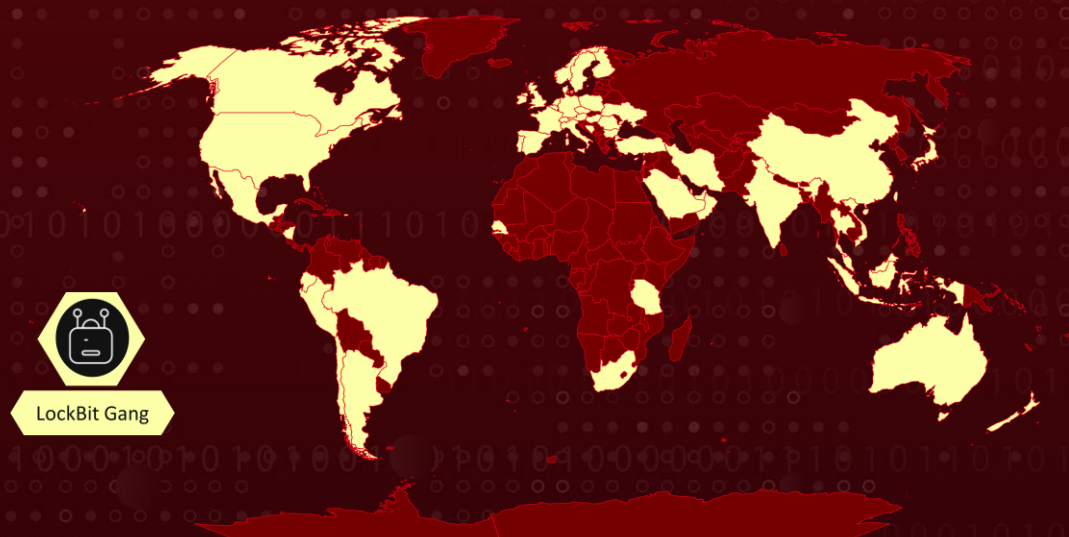
Summary

LockBit 3.0 (LockBit Black), a new variant of LockBit Ransomware, is deploying Cobalt Strike beacons on compromised systems by exploiting the Windows Defender command line tool and Log4j in VMware Horizon.

🔧 CVE Table

CVE	NAME	PATCH
CVE-2021-44228	Apache Log4j Remote Code Execution impacting VMware Horizon	✓

🗺️ Actor Map



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Potential MITRE ATT&CK TTPs

TA0001 Initial Access	TA0004 Privilege Escalation	TA0003 Persistence	TA0005 Defense Evasion
TA0002 Execution	TA0009 Collection	T1056 Input Capture	T1190 Exploit Public-Facing Application
T1059 Command and Scripting Interpreter	T1059.001 PowerShell	T1140 Deobfuscate/Decode Files or Information	T1574 Hijack Execution Flow
T1574.002 DLL Side-Loading	T1553 Subvert Trust Controls	T1553.002 Code Signing	

Technical Details

- #1

Threat actor associated with LockBit 3.0 gains initial access via the Log4j vulnerability(CVE-2021-44228) in the unpatched VMware Horizon Server. After gaining initial access, reconnaissance began by executing commands in PowerShell and exfiltrating the command output via a POST base64 encoded request to an IP address.
- #2

The attacker attempts to download three files: a clean copy of a Windows CL utility (in this case, MpCmdRun), a DLL file (weaponized mpclient.dll), and a LOG file and runs them using PowerShell after getting sufficient rights.
- #3

After being run, the code decrypts an encrypted Cobalt Strike payload from the "c0000015.log" file, which dropped together with the other two files from the previous stage of the attack.

Actor Detail

NAME	MOTIVE	TARGET LOCATIONS	TARGET INDUSTRIES
LockBit Gang	Financial Gain	Argentina, Australia, Austria, Bahrain, Belgium, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Brazil, Bulgaria, Canada, Cayman Islands, Chile, China, Cyprus, Czech Republic, Denmark, Ecuador, Finland, France, Germany, Hong Kong, Hungary, India, Indonesia, Iran, Ireland, Isle of Man, Italy, Japan, Kuwait, Lebanon, Malaysia, Mauritius, Mexico, Netherlands, New Zealand, Nicaragua, Norway, Oman, Peru, Poland, Portugal, Puerto Rico, Qatar, Romania, Saudi Arabia, Senegal, Singapore, South Africa, Spain, Sweden, Switzerland, Taiwan, Tanzania, Thailand, Turkey, United Arab Emirates, United Kingdom, United States, Vietnam, Ukraine	Automotive, Aviation, Biotechnology, Chemicals, Construction & Engineering, Consumer, Defense, Distributors, Education, Electrical, Energy, Family Services, Financial, Food Products, Healthcare, Hotels, Insurance, IT, Machinery, Marine, Media, Metals & Mining, Oil and Gas, Pharmaceuticals, Professional Services, Real Estate, Retail, Telecommunication, Transportation, Utilities

✂ Indicator of Compromise (IOC)

TYPE	VALUE
SHA1	a512215a000d1b21f92dbef5d8d57a420197d262, 729eb505c36c08860c4408db7be85d707bdcfb1b, 10039d5e5ee5710a067c58e76cd8200451e54b55, ff01473073c5460d1e544f5b17cd25dadf9da513, e35a702db47cb11337f523933acd3bce2f60346d, 82bd4273fa76f20d51ca514e1070a3369a89313b, 091b490500b5f827cc8cde41c9a7f68174d11302, 0815277e12d206c5bbb18fd1ade99bf225ede5db, eed31d16d3673199b34b48fb74278df8ec15ae33
Domains	info.openjdklab[.]xyz
IPV4	139.180.184[.]147, 45.32.108[.]54, 149.28.137[.]7

✂ Recent Breaches

<http://tekinox.it/>

<https://www.business.gov.om/ieasy/wp/en/>

<https://kangaroo.vn/>

<https://overseas-ast.com/>

<https://www.preflooring.com/>

<https://www.iis.ac.uk/>

<https://kuwaitflourmills.com/Home>

✂ Patch Links

<https://www.vmware.com/security/advisories/VMSA-2021-0028.html>

✂ References

<https://www.sentinelone.com/blog/living-off-windows-defender-lockbit-ransomware-sideloads-cobalt-strike-through-microsoft-security-tool/>

What Next?

Book a free demo with **HivePro Uni5** to check your exposure to this advisory. HivePro Uni5 is a Threat Exposure Management Solution that proactively reduces an organization's attack surface before it gets exploited.



At Hive Pro we take a long hard look at your vulnerabilities so you can bolster your defenses and fine-tune your offensive cybersecurity tactics.

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August 3, 2022 • 7:00 AM

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